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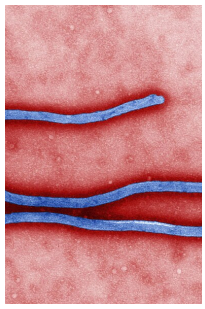
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STATE POLICE: 25 ASSEMBLIES APPROVE AMENDMENT, PASSING TWO-THIRDS MARK

Twenty-five state assemblies have now approved the constitutional amendment for state police, more than the 24 required, says Chief of Staff Femi Gbajabiamila.

By Today Newspaper Staff

ABUJA — Twenty-five of Nigeria's 36 state Houses of Assembly have approved the constitutional amendment that would allow states to establish their own police, passing the two-thirds threshold required by the Constitution.



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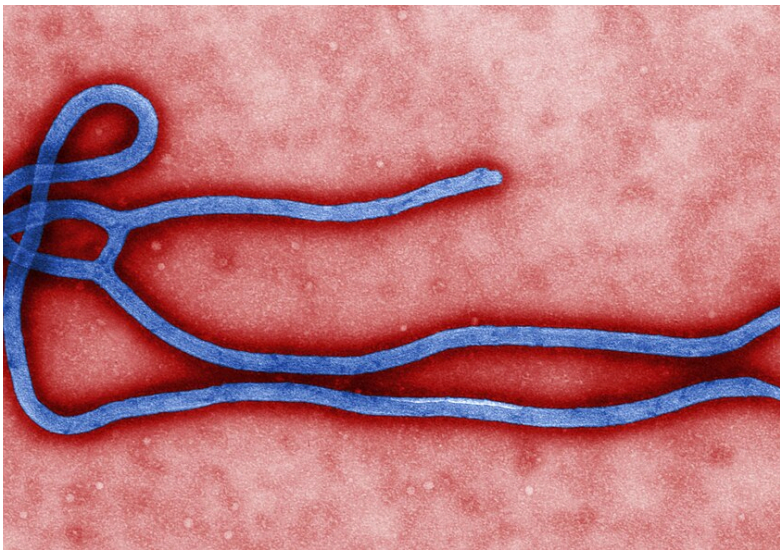
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NATION

EBOLA: ABUJA PATIENT RECOVERING AS TESTS LINK VIRUS CLOSELY TO KENYA CASE



ABUJA — Genome sequencing has shown that the Ebola virus detected in Nigeria's first confirmed case differs by only one mutation from the virus found in Kenya's first imported case, the Coordinating Minister of Health and Social Welfare, Professor Muhammad Ali Pate, said on Friday.

The sequencing was carried out by the Nigeria Centre for Disease Control and Prevention (NCDC) and the Institute of Genomics and Global Health at Redeemer's University, Ede. Pate cautioned that the result does not show how the Abuja patient was infected, and said there was no evidence of travel linking the two patients. Africa CDC is investigating, as both passed through Entebbe airport in Uganda on 3 October.

The minister said the patient is recovering and her latest laboratory results show great improvement. Nigeria still has one confirmed case; some contacts have tested negative and other results are pending.

Briefing the National Economic Council on Thursday, Pate said 21 states had updated their Ebola response plans and urged the remaining 15 to speed up. Hospitals have been told to prepare isolation beds, and private facilities must report suspected cases. He said large gatherings are not restricted for now, but this could be reviewed. Ebola spreads through contact with body fluids, not through the air.

Inside Zamfara Communities Paying for Bandits' Reprisals



GUSAU — Residents of communities in Dansadau Emirate, Maru Local Government Area of Zamfara State, say they are bearing the cost of reprisal attacks by bandits, according to a field report by Premium Times. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

653 Terrorism Suspects Convicted in Latest Mass Trial

The Attorney-General says 880 of 1,060 cases have been heard in the 11th phase of terrorism trials at the Federal High Court, Abuja.

Enugu Police Admit Officers Shot Entertainer 'Stone' During Raid

Police say Izuchukwu Nnaji was shot during a struggle for an officer's gun; the commissioner has ordered an investigation after youths protested.

Floods Have Killed 245 People and Displaced Nearly 215,000 in 2026, Says NEMA

The emergency agency says 673,350 people in 28 states have been affected by floods this year.

11 Killed as Trailer Rams Into Vehicles in Gombe

A trailer with failed brakes hit two cars and five motorcycles at Tashan Magarya junction in Kumo, Akko LGA.

Malaria Rate Among Children Falls to 15.2%, Survey Shows

The 2025 Malaria Indicator Survey shows prevalence among young children fell from 22 per cent in 2021; the government targets a 50 per cent cut by 2030.

Customs Says Applicants Who Used 'Backdoor' Were Removed From Recruitment List

The Nigeria Customs Service says 397 applicants were disqualified at screening, as the Federal Character Commission calls for the exercise to be suspended.

POLITICS

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State Police: 25 Assemblies Approve Amendment, Passing Two-Thirds Mark

The Chief of Staff to the President, Femi Gbajabiamila, who chairs the Presidential Working Group on the National Policing Bill, disclosed this in a statement. The assemblies yet to approve the Constitution (Sixth Alteration) Bill 2026 are Lagos, Ondo, Ebonyi, Kogi, Niger, Borno, Bauchi, Jigawa, Katsina, Kano and Sokoto.

The draft National Policing Bill and 29 related amendment bills were sent to the Attorney-General of the Federation on 19 October for a drafting review and are due back by 30 October. Gbajabiamila has described the policing bill as the most important bill of the administration so far.

The amendment, passed by the Senate on 24 June and the House of Representatives on 23 July, was sent to the states on 16 September. It creates a Federal Police Service and state police services under a new section of the Constitution, and allows the President to take over a state police service in defined circumstances.

The amendment still needs presidential assent. The National Policing Bill must then be passed, and each state must enact its own law before any state police force can begin operating. President Bola Tinubu set up the working group on 7 July 2026.

Macron's State Visit to Nigeria Called Off, Business Forum Postponed

ABUJA — A state visit to Nigeria by French President Emmanuel Macron, planned for Wednesday, 28 October, has been called off, Premium Times reported, citing Nigerian officials.

According to the sources, Macron and President Bola Tinubu agreed on Thursday to cancel the trip. Reasons cited include the protests that have disrupted France since September, the approach of Nigeria's presidential election in about three months, and the recently confirmed Ebola case in Nigeria. The French Embassy declined to comment, while the spokesperson for the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Olufemi Adeniyi, said the ministry had no such information and would announce any official change.

On Saturday, the France-Nigeria Business Council informed participants by email that its business forum, scheduled for 29 October in Lagos, had been postponed. The email said the two presidents had jointly decided to postpone the state visit, which is now expected in 2027, and that a new date for the forum would be announced.

The visit was meant to return President Tinubu's three-day state visit to France in 2024.

Tinubu Takes 2027 Campaign to Kaduna



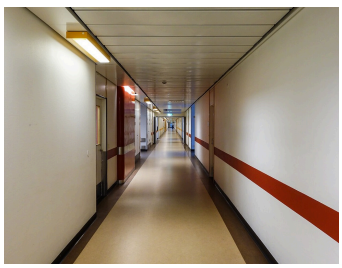
KADUNA — President Bola Tinubu, the presidential candidate of the All Progressives Congress (APC), is due to begin the northern leg of his 2027 campaign on Saturday at the Kaduna Township Stadium, with all seven North-West governors expected to attend.

Campaigning for the presidential and National Assembly elections opened on 19 August and runs until 15 January 2027, according to the Independent National Electoral Commission (INEC).

The choice of Kaduna has drawn debate. Critics point to insecurity in the state, the detention of former governor Nasir El-Rufai and anti-government chants heard at some northern gatherings. Tinubu lost Kaduna to Atiku Abubakar in the 2023 election. Supporters say the city remains the political centre of the North. The APC's publicity secretary in the state, Mohammed Sani Haruna, cited its history as the former capital of the Northern Region and Governor Uba Sani's ties to the President.

Former Defence Minister Muhammad Badaru Abubakar, who leads the Arewa for Asiwaju group, said it planned to bring more than 10,000 supporters from the 19 northern states and the FCT. The Kaduna police spokesperson, DSP Mansir Hassan, said several security agencies had been deployed and some roads would be closed.

Atiku, APC Trade Words Over N10bn Ebola Fund



ABUJA — The presidential candidate of the African Democratic Congress (ADC), Atiku Abubakar, has asked the Federal Government to explain what became of the N10 billion approved for Ebola preparedness in June. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

One Killed as Gunmen Attack NDC Candidate's Convoy in Ebonyi



ABAKALIKI — One person has died and three others were injured after gunmen attacked the convoy of Rollins Offia-Nwali, the Nigeria Democratic Congress (NDC) candidate for the Ezza South constituency in the Ebonyi State House of Assembly. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

INEC: Results That Don't Match BVAS Will Not Be Uploaded to IReV

ABUJA — The Independent National Electoral Commission (INEC) says any polling unit result that does not match the figures recorded on the Bimodal Voter Accreditation System (BVAS) will not be uploaded to its results viewing portal, IReV. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

Kwankwaso Promises Security, Education and Jobs at Jos Town Hall

JOS — The vice-presidential candidate of the Nigeria Democratic Congress (NDC), Rabiu Kwankwaso, has said a government led by Peter Obi would give priority to security, education, agriculture and jobs. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

ECONOMY

PETROL SUPPLY FALLS 23% IN SEPTEMBER AS IMPORTS AND LOCAL RECEIPTS DROP



ABUJA — The amount of petrol supplied to the Nigerian market fell by about 23 per cent in September, according to the latest factsheet of the Nigerian Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Regulatory Authority (NMDPRA).

Daily petrol receipts dropped from 50.5 million litres in August to 38.7 million litres, even as consumption rose by 7 per cent to 44.4 million litres a day. Supply from local refineries fell by 21 per cent to 28.5 million litres a day, while imports fell by 30 per cent to 10.2 million litres.

The Dangote refinery's petrol output rose by 13 per cent to 47.22 million litres a day, with the plant running at about 106 per cent of its 650,000 barrels-per-day capacity. Its petrol exports rose 59 per cent to 15.47 million litres a day, and its stocks closed the month at 366.2 million litres.

Indicative pump prices stood at N1,371.01 a litre in Lagos, N1,420.01 in Abuja, N1,447.75 in Kano and N1,464.75 in Maiduguri.

Diesel receipts fell 40 per cent to 8.7 million litres a day, the lowest level in 13 months, while Dangote's diesel exports rose 82 per cent. Crude oil delivered to local refineries fell 9 per cent to 618,000 barrels a day. Gas supply dipped 2.2 per cent, while cooking gas receipts rose 9 per cent.

Smuggled Imports and Costly Loans Hurting Local Manufacturers, Says Halba Foods Chief



KANO — The Managing Director of Halba Foods, Halifa Bala Rabiu, says smuggled imports and difficult access to credit are among the biggest threats facing Nigerian manufacturers. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

FG, Bi-Courtney Settle 19-Year Dispute Over Lagos Airport Terminal Two



LAGOS — The Federal Government, the Federal Airports Authority of Nigeria (FAAN), Bi-Courtney Ltd and Stabilini Visinoni Ltd have signed a settlement ending a dispute of more than 18 years over Terminal Two of Murtala Muhammed Airport (MMA2) in Lagos. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

OPay Targets Up to $4.4bn Valuation in US Stock Market Listing



LAGOS — Mobile payments company OPay is seeking a valuation of up to $4.42 billion in its planned listing in the United States, the company said on Friday. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

First HoldCo's Nine-Month Profit Rises to N744.5bn

The banking group's profit after tax rose by about 65 per cent, driven by higher fees and gains on financial instruments.

Guinness Nigeria's Nine-Month Profit Rises 53% to N40.7bn

Higher sales lifted the brewer's revenue to N403.3bn; shareholders will receive an interim dividend of N7 per share.

Private Sector Credit Falls by N537.6bn in September

CBN data show lending to the private sector dropped to N83.93trn, despite the Monetary Policy Committee's 350-basis-point rate cut.

EDUCATION

REPEATED STRIKES HAVE COST FCT PUPILS OVER 180 SCHOOL DAYS SINCE 2023



ABUJA — Pupils in public primary schools in the Federal Capital Territory have lost more than 180 school days to at least six major strikes since September 2023, according to a Weekend Trust special report.

The latest strike by FCT workers began on 7 October and was suspended on 20 October, with teachers told to return to class on 21 October. A strike from March to July 2025 ended only after the six area councils released N16 billion.

Parents interviewed said they had paid for private lessons, moved children to private schools or sent them to learn trades during the strikes. The FCT chairman of the Nigeria Union of Teachers, Abdullahi Mohammed Shafas, rejected a rule linking promotions to available vacancies and denied that the strikes were political. The FCT Administration did not respond to requests for comment. Education experts warned that repeated strikes would push more children out of school.

Rivers Opens Probe Into Alleged Virginity Tests on Schoolgirls



PORT HARCOURT — The Rivers State Ministry of Education has opened an investigation into allegations that a traditional ruler forced female students of Government Comprehensive High School, Taabaa, in Khana Local Government Area, to undergo virginity checks. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

Anchor University Marks 10 Years With Combined Convocation



LAGOS — Anchor University, Lagos, will hold its combined sixth and seventh convocation ceremonies as part of events marking its 10th anniversary, from 16 to 22 November 2026. The convocation itself takes place on 21 November.

The Vice-Chancellor, Professor Samuel Bandele, whose tenure ends early next year, said these would be the last convocations under his leadership. Responding to concerns from parents about space, he said the new governing council had begun moving the university to its permanent site, with temporary accommodation in place in the meantime.

The programme includes a worship service, community service, an entrepreneurship exhibition, a football match, an alumni summit, and the anniversary and convocation lectures with a book launch.

Kano Approves Promotion of 18,984 SUBEB Staff



KANO — Kano State Governor Abba Kabir Yusuf has approved the promotion of 18,984 teaching and non-teaching staff of the State Universal Basic Education Board (SUBEB), covering the January and July 2026 promotion cycles. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

IGP Urges Schools to Put Prevention First on Safety



LAGOS — The Inspector-General of Police, Tunji Disu, has urged schools to put prevention at the centre of their safety plans, with intelligence gathering, early warning systems, emergency drills and prompt reporting of threats. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

ENTERTAINMENT

NOLLYWOOD ACTOR FRANCIS DURU DIES AT 57

LAGOS — Nollywood actor Francis Duru has died at the age of 57, his family announced on Friday, saying he died after a brief illness. The Actors Guild of Nigeria confirmed his death.

Born in Cameroon to parents from Imo State, Duru studied theatre arts at the University of Port Harcourt. He made his screen debut in "Missing Mark" in 1989 and became widely known in 1995 as the young Ahanna in Amaka Igwe's "Rattlesnake". His other films include "Blood Money", "Stigma" and "The Good Husband".

He served as interim president of the Actors Guild of Nigeria in 2010 and was named a UN Ambassador of Peace in 2007. Tributes have come from colleagues and organisations including the Africa Women Conference, which described him as a long-standing member of its family. He is survived by his wife and children.

RMD to Deliver Keynote at PAO Digital Content Regulation Conference



LAGOS — Veteran actor Richard Mofe-Damijo (RMD) will deliver the keynote address at the sixth International Peace Anyiam-Osigwe (PAO) Nigeria Digital Content Regulation Conference, to be held in Lagos on 18 and 19 November 2026.

The theme of the conference is "Film and Content Production in the Digital Era: Balancing Regulation and Innovation". According to the National Film and Video Censors Board (NFVCB), he follows Mo Abudu (2024) and Bolanle Austen-Peters (2025) as keynote speaker.

Mofe-Damijo has featured in more than 60 film and television productions. A former journalist and founder of RMD Productions, he also served as Delta State Commissioner for Culture and Tourism. The NFVCB Executive Director, Dr Shaibu Husseini, welcomed his acceptance.

AFRIFF 2026 to Open With Olive Nwosu's Debut Feature 'Lady'



LAGOS — The 15th Africa International Film Festival (AFRIFF) will open in Lagos on 1 November with "Lady", the first feature film by Olive Nwosu, and run until 7 November under the theme "Frames of the Future: Africa's Creative Intelligence".

"Lady" follows a young Lagos taxi driver who drives sex workers on their night rounds, one of whom is a childhood friend. The festival will close with "It's the Blackness", the directorial debut of actor Hakeem Kae-Kazim, produced by Dapo Oshiyemi, a comedy-drama about two friends, Eniola and Jordan.

The festival's founder, Chioma Ude, said African cinema is entering an exciting new chapter. The programme includes screenings, masterclasses and the Africa Film and Content Market.

Jagun Jagun 2 Adds K1, Pasuma and Funke Akindele to Cast



LAGOS — Femi Adebayo's epic "Jagun Jagun 2: The War of Warriors" will be released on 4 December 2026, with Fuji stars King Wasiu Ayinde Marshall (K1 De Ultimate) and Wasiu Alabi Pasuma, as well as actress Funke Akindele, joining the cast.

Several actors from the first film, including Odunlade Adekola, Lateef Adedimeji and Bimbo Ademoye, are expected to return. Adebayo said on social media that the sequel took two years of relentless work.

The first "Jagun Jagun" won two awards at the 2024 Africa Magic Viewers' Choice Awards, for Best Indigenous Language Movie (West Africa) and Best Costume Design, and three awards at the 2024 Africa Movie Academy Awards.

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